Final project question bank

Tuesday, November 3
Due Wednesday, November 4, 11:59 p.m.

Choose one question and start with its two passages. On the course site, each question opens to show its key figures, links to the readings, and a first step for Wednesday.

POLITICS

Who won the Great Debate, and why didn't the losers disappear?
Start: *Analects* 2.3 + *Han Feizi*, ch. 7 (p. 333)

Why wasn't there another Qin, or was there?
Start: Li Si (SCT 207–212) + Lu Jia, *New Discourses* (Han philosophy packet)

How could Korea and Japan borrow China's institutions without accepting China's rule?
Start: Silla's reply (SKT 64–65) + Taika edicts (SJT 77–79)

CULTURE

Why did rulers need monks, and sometimes fear them?
Start: Huiyuan (SCT 427–429) + Wang Geon, injunctions 1–2 (SKT 154)

Could a woman influence politics without holding office?
Start: *Genji*, ch. 1 + Zhu Xi's *Ancestral Rites* (CC 157–163)

What ancient ideas still live on today, and who kept them alive?
Start: *Laozi* 37 + *Han Feizi*, ch. 5 (pp. 324–325)

WAR

Why did rulers celebrate wars that Mozi condemned?
Start: *Mozi*, ch. 17 + *Salt and Iron*, minister (CC 61)

How did Buddhists justify fighting wars?
Start: Wongwang (SKT 45–46) + Huiyuan (SCT 427–429)

When is rebellion the right thing to do?
Start: *Mengzi* 1B8 + *Han Feizi*, ch. 7 (p. 333)

ECONOMICS

Salt and Iron: should the state run the economy?
Start: *Salt and Iron* (CC 61): minister + learned men

Does a strong state need weak people?
Start: *Lord Shang* 20.1 (p. 143) + *Mengzi* 1A7

Why did rulers call farming essential and commerce dangerous?
Start: *Lord Shang* 3.2 (p. 134) + *Salt and Iron* (CC 61)

PHILOSOPHY

How did Daoism persist?
Start: *Laozi* 37 + *Han Feizi*, ch. 5 (pp. 324–325)

How did Fo (Buddhism) spread across East Asia?
Start: Huiyuan (SCT 427–429) + Wongwang (SKT 45–46)

What is the legacy of Mo (Mohism)?
Start: *Mozi*, ch. 17 + *Salt and Iron* (CC 61)

What helped Ru (Confucianism) evolve?
Start: *Analects* 2.3 + Zhu Xi's *Ancestral Rites* (CC 157–163)

Choose a question

Your question:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Build your question

Name: _____

Sources. Which two passages will you start with? Give the source and page or section.

People. Who is speaking in each passage, and who else matters to your question?

Texts. What other course texts could you add to reach two periods and three societies?

Secondary questions. What further questions does your question raise?

ID bank

PEOPLE

Wu Ding
Fu Hao
Kongzi
Mozi
Laozi
Zhuangzi
Mengzi
Xunzi
Lord Shang
Han Feizi
First Emperor
Li Si
Liu Bang
Lu Jia
Dong Zhongshu
Ban Zhao
Huiyuan
Wongwang
Empress Wu
King Sinmun
Shotoku
Wang Anshi
Zhu Xi
Wang Geon
Fujiwara no Michinaga
Murasaki Shikibu

PLACES

Anyang
Sanxingdui
Luoyang
Qin
Xianyang
Han
Chang'an
Silla
Tang
Kaifeng
Song
Hangzhou
Heian-kyo
Goryeo
Gaegyeong

TEXTS AND ARTWORKS

Shijing
Shujing
Analects
Mozi
Laozi
Zhuangzi
Mengzi
Xunzi
Han Feizi
Book of Lord Shang
Shiji
Debate on Salt and Iron
sutras
Tale of Genji
sculptures
Qingming Festival Scroll

CONCEPTS

Tianxia
Tianming
Dao
De
Ren
Xiao
Wuwei
Jian'ai
the sprouts
the Two Handles
portents
bodhisattva
Tenno

THINGS

oracle bones
ritual bronzes
terracotta army
salt and iron monopolies
household registers
Grand Canal
Buddhist temples
cave temples
paper money
print technology
ancestral rites
kana
Palgwan festival

SCT: *Sources of Chinese Tradition* · SKT: *Sources of Korean Tradition* · SJT: *Sources of Japanese Tradition* · CC: *Chinese Civilization: A Sourcebook*. Other page numbers refer to the assigned course readers.